

Chunxiao Jing

+1-608-504-8549 | cjing7@wisc.edu

Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison

216 Taylor Hall, 427 Lorch Street, Madison, WI 53706

EDUCATION

- **University of Wisconsin-Madison** August, 2021-May, 2027(expected)
Ph.D., Agricultural and Applied Economics Madison, WI
Committee: Jeremy Foltz (Chair), Gisella Kagy, Vladimir Gimpelson
- **University of California, Los Angeles** June, 2019
M.A., Applied Economics Los Angeles, CA
- **Nankai University** June, 2018
B.A., Economics Tianjin, China

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Primary Fields: Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Secondary Fields: Labor Economics, Structural Change, Environmental Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Weather Shocks and Structural Transformation: Micro Evidence from Africa

Abstract. Structural transformation, the movement of labor from agriculture to more productive non-agricultural activities, is a central driver of economic development. Classical theories emphasize different stages of this process, including labor release from agriculture (Lewis, 1954), labor reallocation under transition frictions, and labor absorption into non-agricultural employment (Harris and Todaro, 1970). This paper develops a structural framework that unifies these perspectives by decomposing structural transformation into three sequential stages: labor release, labor reallocation, and labor absorption. Using household panel data from the Living Standards Measurement Study (LSMS) for Niger, Malawi, and Ethiopia, combined with high-resolution climate and geospatial data, I first provide reduced-form evidence on how weather-induced agricultural productivity shocks constructed using Random Forest affect each stage of the transformation process. I then estimate a structural model using the simulated method of moments and conduct counterfactual policy analysis. The results reveal substantial heterogeneity in the mechanisms governing structural transformation across countries. Subsistence constraints are the primary barrier in Niger and Malawi, whereas labor reallocation frictions and limited labor absorption constrain structural transformation in Ethiopia. These findings suggest that no single policy can effectively promote structural transformation across countries. By identifying the binding constraint at each stage, the proposed framework provides a unified approach for understanding labor allocation and designing country-specific development policies.

WORKING PAPERS

Can the Service Sector Lead Structural Transformation in Africa? Evidence from Côte d'Ivoire [\[Link\]](#)

with Jeremy Foltz

In this paper, we examine whether expansion of the service sector can become a driver of structural transformation in Côte d'Ivoire by analyzing labor demand and sectoral productivity. Using proxy-variable estimates of total factor productivity, we find that service-sector productivity is 2.46 times higher than manufacturing productivity, and that high-productivity service firms hire more workers overall, particularly unskilled workers. The results suggest that the service sector can lead structural transformation and GDP growth in Africa.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Gender Constraints and Labor Allocation during Structural Transformation

Climate Change and Conflict: Causal Evidence with New Machine-Learning Methods with Jeremy Foltz

BOOK CHAPTERS

Perspectives on *The Agricultural Wealth of Nations* with Héctor Paredes

Forthcoming, Proceedings of the British Academy

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Wisconsin–Madison Research Assistant to Prof. Jeremy Foltz	Madison, WI Fall, 2022 – Present
University of California, Los Angeles Research Assistant, MAE Research Lab	Los Angeles, CA Spring, 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

• Principles of Microeconomics (Econ 101) Taught by Dr Steve Trost	Teaching Assistant Fall, 2026
• The Growth and Development of Nations in the Global Economy (AAE 374) Taught by Professor Vladimir Gimpelson	Teaching Assistant Spring, 2024
• The Growth and Development of Nations in the Global Economy (AAE 374) Taught by Professor Jeremy Foltz	Teaching Assistant Spring, 2023

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

* INDICATES UPCOMING

2027	ASSA Annual Meeting*
2026	NEUDC*, MEA Annual Meeting, AAEA Annual Meeting, AAE Development Workshop
2025	ASSA Annual Meeting, AAE Development Workshop
2024	CSAE Conference, CES China Annual Conference, AAEA Annual Meeting
2023	AAE Development Workshop

FUNDING AND GRANTS

AAE Research Travel Grant, 2026-2027, \$1,000
Graduate Student Research Grants, Research Travel Funds, 2026-2027, \$1,500
STEG Small Research Grant, 2026-2027, £5,000
STEG PhD Research Grant, 2026-2027, £10,000
University of Wisconsin-Madison PhD Fellowship, 2025-2026, \$35,636
AAE Conference Travel Grant, 2024-2025, \$1,000
AAE Conference Travel Grant, 2023-2024, \$1,000
University of Wisconsin-Madison PhD Fellowship, 2021-2022, \$30,545

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

• Mentor Service Mentor, The Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN) Program	2022-2023 and 2024-2025
• Department Service The Taylor-Hibbard Club President, University of Wisconsin-Madison	2023-2024

LANGUAGE AND COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)
Computer Skills: Python, Stata, R, L ^A T _E X, QGIS, SPSS
Methodological Expertise: Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Structural Modeling

REFERENCES

Jeremy Foltz Professor Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics University of Wisconsin–Madison jdfoltz@wisc.edu	Gisella Kagy Assistant Professor Department of Consumer Science University of Wisconsin–Madison gkagy@wisc.edu
Vladimir Gimpelson Professor Centre for Labour Market Studies Higher School of Economics vladim.gimpelson@gmail.com	